
WES HENDERSON

STAFF SYSTEMS ENGINEER

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AUTOMATION ENGINEERING | CONTAINERIZATION | LINUX/UNIX

Automation-focused Systems Engineer with 10+ years of experience in designing, integrating, and optimizing scalable infrastructure in cloud-native environments. Strong Linux advocate with deep technical acumen in automation, DevOps, and systems architecture. Skilled in mentoring, documentation, and fostering cross-functional collaboration. Proven ability to deliver innovative solutions that drive cost savings, reduce incident response times, and elevate organizational resilience.

CORE COMPETENCIES

DevOps | Research | Mentoring | Technical Documentation | Communication | Adaptability | Cloud Infrastructure Automation | Problem Solving | Team Leadership & Mentoring | People Management | Infrastructure Engineering Management

Project Management | Complex Systems | Technical Leadership | System Optimization | Systems Design Troubleshooting | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Systems Engineering | System Architecture | QA/QC | Incident Response

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Bash (Advanced), PowerShell (Advanced)
- **Tools & Platforms:** Linux/Unix Systems, Kubernetes (AKS & GKE), Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), GitHub, Terraform, AWS CloudFormation, Grafana, Splunk, Ansible, Chef, Puppet, Salt, Docker, Apache, MySQL, Nginx, RESTful Web Services, boto3 (AWS SDK), Fabric
- **Technologies:** Kubernetes, Helm, CI/CD Pipelines, Python & Bash Scripting, REST APIs, Configuration Management, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Public Cloud Infrastructure, SOA (Service-Oriented Architecture), Microservices, Integration, Testing, SRE Tooling, Containerization, Network Architecture

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Salesforce, San Francisco, CA

Nov 2019 – Apr 2025

Lead Systems Engineer, Remote

Led strategic DevOps and systems initiatives across Mulesoft and Pardot, enabling key security features and delivering scalable, cost-effective infrastructure solutions.

- Spearheaded the 'Bring Your Own Key' (BYOK) initiative, securing \$6M in recurring revenue and satisfying key enterprise customer requirements.
- Discovered and resolved critical cloud misconfigurations, saving \$3M annually in AWS infrastructure costs.
- Orchestrated the seamless onboarding of multiple business units to centralized infrastructure, ensuring full documentation and zero service disruptions.
- Designed and implemented a custom CLI tool for managing asynchronous jobs, significantly reducing MTTR and boosting operational visibility.
- Developed a reusable SRE tooling pipeline that reduced tribal knowledge dependencies and improved incident recovery workflows.
- Facilitated alignment and collaboration across multiple teams to deliver infrastructure projects on time and within budget.

TrueAbility, San Antonio, TX

Feb 2018 – Nov 2019

Deployment Engineer

Delivered high-stakes technical exam platforms for global tech clients and maintained hybrid cloud infrastructure, supporting internal and customer-facing tools.

- Designed and launched exams for major clients including Google, Elastic, Chef, Linux Foundation, and VMWare, increasing customer base and revenue.
- Mentored junior engineers and built documentation/playbooks, reducing escalations and supporting career development within the team.
- Engineered customized exam environments using Bash and PowerShell, rapidly adapting to client needs across a wide tech stack.
- Contributed to internal infrastructure and codebase supporting AWS and GCP hybrid environments for exam delivery and tooling.
- Created demonstration assessments that expanded company offerings into recruitment-focused products.

Rackspace Hosting, San Antonio, TX

May 2013 – Dec 2017

DevOps Engineer

Built scalable cloud architectures in AWS for regulated industries and led automation efforts to streamline deployments and reduce operational friction.

- Delivered 2–3 custom AWS deployments per week, adhering to compliance standards (e.g., PCI, HIPAA).
- Authored a Python-based automation framework to accelerate builds, cutting deployment failure rates in half.
- Enhanced customer satisfaction by creating custom tools in Bash and Python that streamlined onboarding and troubleshooting.
- Supported knowledge sharing through active contributions to internal wikis and public blog content.
- Acted as a technical liaison to educate clients on distributed systems and DevOps best practices.

EDUCATION

Associate of Applied Science (AAS) in Computer Forensics — 4.0 GPA

Northwest Vista College – San Antonio, TX

- *Marketable Skills Achievement Award: Linux RHCT*
- *Marketable Skills Achievement Award: Information Security & Assurance*

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

1. **AWS Certified Solutions Architect**, Amazon Web Services (AWS), Jan 2017 – Jan 2019
2. **Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE)**, Red Hat, Apr 2016 – Apr 2019
3. **Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA)**, Red Hat, Jul 2013 – Apr 2019
4. **CloudU**, Rackspace Technology, Mar 2013
5. **LPIC-1: Linux Server Professional Certification**, Linux Professional Institute (LPI), Mar 2012 – Mar 2017
6. **CompTIA Linux+ (Powered by LPI) Certification**, CompTIA, 2012
7. **Data Center Technical Specialist**, Novell, Mar 2012
8. **SUSE Certified Administrator in Enterprise Linux 11**, SUSE, Mar 2012
9. **Certified Linux Administrator**, Novell, Mar 2012 – Mar 2017
10. **CompTIA Network+ Certification**, CompTIA, Dec 2010
11. **CompTIA Security+ Certification**, CompTIA, Dec 2010
12. **CompTIA A+ Certification**, CompTIA

PUBLICATIONS

1. Henderson, Wes. (Dec 19, 2015). [The Anatomy of an SSH Connection](#). necrux.com.
2. Henderson, Wes. (Apr 28, 2015). Understanding and Adopting a Cloud Mindset for your Emerging Business. Rackspace Blog.
3. Henderson, Wes. (Aug 28, 2014). An Overview Of Disaster Recovery And Mitigation In The Cloud For Emerging Businesses. Rackspace Blog.